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UAE, EGYPT LEADERS MEET IN CAIRO TO STRENGTHEN TIES

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Egyptian President Abdel Fattah Al Sissi met in Cairo yesterday to discuss strengthening fraternal ties and broadening bilateral cooperation in support of both nations' development goals. The meeting explored opportunities to enhance collaboration across various fields, with a particular focus on economic, trade and development sectors.

Trump presses Netanyahu on Gaza

Plan calls for truce, Israeli withdrawal and release of hostages

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

At the White House yesterday, US President Donald Trump pressed Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu on a 21-point Gaza peace plan, highlighting rare strains between the US president and one of his closest allies.

The high-stakes talks came as the Gaza war neared its second year, with more than

66,000 Palestinians killed, according to health officials, and Israel vowing to "finish the job" against Hamas.

Scepticism

Trump's envoy Steve Witkoff circulated a plan calling for an immediate ceasefire, a phased Israeli withdrawal, and the release of hostages within 48 hours, followed by Israel freeing 1,000 Palestinian prisoners. White House Press Secretary Karoline Leavitt said Trump's goal was simple: "He wants this war to come to an end, he wants to see all the hostages released."

Reports suggested former UK prime minister Tony Blair could

head a transitional Gaza authority, though Netanyahu last week rejected any Palestinian Authority role in governing the enclave.

Families of Israeli hostages urged Trump to stand firm, even as Israeli strikes in Khan Yunis killed four more Palestinians yesterday.

In Gaza, residents expressed both scepticism and hope that Trump's plan could end the devastation.

For Trump, the push offers a chance at a breakthrough eluding past US presidents.

For Netanyahu, it marks perhaps his toughest Washington visit yet.

SEE ALSO PAGE 11

UAE unveils new visas to attract talent

ENTRY PERMIT FOR AI SPECIALISTS, BUSINESS EXPLORATION LAUNCHED

ABU DHABI
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The Federal Authority for Identity, Citizenship, Customs and Port Security (ICP) has announced amendments and additions to entry visas.

This includes the launch of four new visit visa categories for specialists in artificial intelligence, entertainment, events, cruise ships and leisure boats.

Specialists in AI can visit the UAE on single or multiple trips for a specified period, provided that a letter is submitted from the sponsor (establishment specialised in the field).

Visit visas will also be granted for attending a festival, exhibition, conference, seminar, or economic, cultural, sports, religious, community, and educational activities.

The business exploration visa requires financial solvency to establish a company, ownership of a share in an existing company outside the country, or proven professional practice, while the truck driver visa requires the presence of a sponsor, as well as health and financial guarantees.

Maj Gen Suhail Saeed Al Khaili, Director-General of ICP, said the decision reflects stud-

ies and assessments conducted by the authority.

Sponsoring relatives

Among the amendments, one key modification has been made in conditions for issuing a visa to visit a friend or relative.

If a foreigner wants to visit a first-degree relative of an expat in the country, the monthly income of the sponsor must not be less than Dh4,000. If the visitor is a second- or third-degree relative, the monthly income must not be less than Dh8,000. If the visitor is a friend, the monthly income must not be less than Dh15,000.

Humanitarian visas

A humanitarian residence permit has also been introduced, valid for a year, with the possibility of extension by the ICP's decision, in accordance with specific conditions.

A residence permit for a foreign widow or divorcee has also been granted for a year, with the possibility of renewal for a similar period, subject to conditions.

The changes support the UAE's goal of opening up to the world and attracting talented individuals, experts, and entrepreneurs, particularly in technology, artificial intelligence, entertainment and tourism.

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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

Birthday surprise awaits you at Dubai Miracle Garden

Dubai Miracle Garden, which opened yesterday, has added a special treat for its visitors this season — if it's your birthday, your entry is free. "All you need to do is show your Emirates ID or passport at the ticket counter to confirm your birthday, and your ticket will be on us," Mohammad Zaher Hammadih, CEO of Dubai Miracle Garden said. That's not all, there are more surprises in store.

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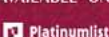
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